

Tasin Academy

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A group of college students were watching television news in their hostel. They were touched by the plight of the flood-affected people in Sunamganj. All the rivers and water bodies there had overflowed their banks because of the onrush of flood water from the hills beyond our border. Their homes, haats, bazaars, shops, and crop lands were under several feet of water. The local administration had rescued the people and accommodated them in schools that were on higher grounds. Villagers in the nearby areas were helping these people in all possible ways. Yet, ensuring drinking water, cleanliness, and hygiene was a big challenge. The schools had toilets but these were clearly not enough. Seeing this situation, Ahmed, Swapan, Rakib, and Niladri quickly decided to go to Sunamganj and work for the flood victims. But to do that, they needed money which they did not have. They began by pooling their own contributions and talked with their classmates, teachers, and local law makers and civil society members for assistance. Everyone came forward to help them. Some guardians also contributed. Their collection was not bad—about Taka 3,00,000—with which they could provide some substantial help to the flood victims. They could buy dry food like high-protein biscuits, gur (molasses), chira (beaten rice), drinking water, water purification tablets, toilet cleaners, and liquid soaps. Their priority was senior citizens, who were over 70 years of age and children. They stayed there for more than a week and then came back after government agencies took over and some flood-affected people started going back home. When the four friends were back in their town, they seemed to have lost some weight but were happy and satisfied that their efforts had been immensely rewarded.

1.A. Choose the correct answer from the alternatives:

(10x0.5=5)

(a) "They were touched by the plight" indicates that:

- (i) People in the flooded areas were suffering very much.
- (ii) They touched the flooded areas under water.
- (iii) Students were upset about the flood victims.
- (iv) Most people died in the flood.

(b) "Pooling their own contributions" implies that:

- (i) The students collected money from their respective vaults.
- (ii) They contributed everything of their own.
- (iii) They took money to help the victims.
- (iv) They donated all their money.

(c) The word "touched" in line 1 could be best replaced by:

- (i) oppressed (ii) suppressed (iii) repressed (iv) depressed

(d) The word "purification" mentioned in the passage means:

- (i) adulteration (ii) clearness (iii) refinement (iv) garbage

(e) What could be an appropriate title of the passage?

- (i) civic engagement rescues flood victims (ii) heroism of youth in Sunamganj
- (iii) flood affected people in Sunamganj (iv) success in alleviating flood disasters

(f) The help that the students did to the people were not:

- (i) significant (ii) substantial (iii) petty (iv) great

(g) What is the purpose of the author of this passage?

- (i) to describe the flood affected people of Sunamganj
- (ii) to explain the humanitarian work of the local leaders
- (iii) to show the sufferings of the flood-affected people
- (iv) to highlight the humanitarian work of the college students

(h) Villagers of the nearby village:

- (i) supplied foods
- (ii) helped them in all possible ways
- (iii) supplied medicines
- (iv) provided drinking water

(i) The school had some toilets but:

- (i) they were sufficient
- (ii) they were not sufficient
- (iii) they were dirty
- (iv) they were unusable

(j) "Their efforts had been immensely rewarded" imply that:

- (i) their hard work was greatly worthwhile
- (ii) people highly praised the students
- (iii) students were highly rewarded
- (iv) people awarded the youth for their contribution

1.B. Answer the following questions:

(5x2=10)

- (a)** What is the moral of the story?
- (b)** Why were they touched?
- (c)** Why, do you think, students as well as people spontaneously lent their hands?
- (d)** "The government can solely face natural disasters." Do you agree/disagree? Give reasons.
- (e)** What can you infer from the incident about the roles of youth in society?

2. Read the passage and complete the table below with the given information. 1x10=10

What/Who	Event/Activity	Why/When/What	When/How
A group of college students	were watching	(i).....	(ii).....
The plight of flood victims	(iii).....	the college students	(iv).....
(v).....	overflowed		their banks
(vi).....	went	(vii).....	under water
(viii).....	accommodated	The flood victims	(ix).....
Villagers	(x).....	In a possible way	nearby areas

Or,

Read the above passage and make a flowchart showing the plights of flood-affected people (One is done for you.)

2x5=10

1. Homelessness	→	2	→	3	→	4	→	5	→	6
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3. Summary Writing

10

Write a summary of the passage in your own words.